Tools — Search

Text and pattern search across files. For code-symbol queries (functions, types, imports) use the Code Intelligence tools instead — the codeindex is faster and returns structured results.

Tool	Description
`grep`	Search file contents for a regex pattern (ripgrep).

Use cases: finding TODO/FIXME comments, matching text in config files and markdown, locating log fragments.

System instruction: "Use `grep` for arbitrary text and pattern matching. Use codeindex tools for code symbol queries."

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grep

Search file contents for a Rust-syntax regex pattern using ripgrep, respecting `.gitignore` rules. Binary files are skipped automatically.

Arguments

Argument	Type	Required	Description	Typical value
`pattern`	string	yes	Regex pattern (Rust regex syntax)	`"TODO"`, `"fn main"`
`path`	string	no	Directory or file to search (default: working directory)	`"src"`
`include`	string	no	Glob restricting which files are searched	`"*.rs"`, `"**/*.ts"`
`exclude`	string	no	Glob of files/directories to exclude	`"vendor/**"`
`case_insensitive`	boolean	no	Case-insensitive matching	`false`
`multiline`	boolean	no	^/$ match line boundaries across lines	`false`
`max_results`	integer	no	Maximum matches returned (max 500)	`500`

Example:

```
grep pattern="TODO" path="src" include="*.rs"
grep pattern="unsafe code" case_insensitive=true
```